OSU · FASHION ENTREPRENEURSHIP · DM 4453

Save a Seat for the Customer

Six versions of one company. One business that found me. Then it's your turn.



Logan Shimmer
Shimmer Labs · Techie Grandkid · Stillwater

WHO THE HECK AM I



Hi, I'm Logan Shimmer.

2009	OSU engineering. **The nerd who liked people too much** to only talk to computers.
15 years	Silicon Valley, as the employee, using AI the whole way: • **Manufacturing:** AI inspecting widgets on the line for quality • **Marketing:** the right message, to the right person, at the right time • **The power grid:** cutting home energy costs, absorbing electric cars
2025	Moved home. Started Shimmer Labs.
Today	Two businesses. **One I kept pushing for a year. One that showed up on its own.**

That was the résumé. **Now the part they don't put on one.**

THE HABIT



The most important person in the room isn't in the room.

Early Amazon left an empty chair in meetings. So did HubSpot. **That's the customer's seat.** Every decision gets argued in front of it. Yes, even the ones you'd rather not ask about.

ASK THE CHAIR
Who actually sits here?

ASK THE CHAIR
What do they hate doing?

ASK THE CHAIR
What would they pay to make it stop?

Not a cute ritual. **It's the cheapest research you'll ever do.**

I STARTED SHIMMER LABS

One company. Six answers to “what do you sell?”

Pulled straight from my website’s edit history. **261 changes in 11 months.** The homepage has been rewritten more than my resume.

1

DAY ONE

Subcontracting

Already sold. Not my customer. **Not my lesson.**

2

FIRST SOLO DEAL

Taddy Podcast API

Brilliant dev, no distribution. Great gig. **Zero repeat.**

3

FEB ’26

Custom software

Endless dream apps stuck in sandboxes. Endless **cash-flow problems.**

4

MAR ’26

Sidecar, the “AI employee”

Bought a machine. Called investors. **Too early, wrong words.**

5

APR ’26

AI Office Hours

Free, walk-in, twice a week. **Finally asked the customer.**

6

AUG ’26

AI Concierge

Free snapshot, $1,500 assessment, $2,000 a month. **Working. Ask me why.**

AI will tell you your idea is great. It’s built to. Your customer isn’t.

PAID IN FULL

Three lessons I paid for so you don't have to

FROM TADDY

Borrow momentum.

Great product, nobody could find it. Zapier and n8n **were** the marketplace. Your own Shopify store versus the boutique everyone already shops at: **start where the customers already are.** Their gravity beats your ambition.

FROM THE DREAM APPS

Ten who'd pay is the milestone.

I'd get their app live, then say: **find ten people who use it and love it.** Not a launch, not an ad budget. Ten. Thirty survey replies saying "cool idea" isn't validation. **Ten saying "I'd pay $40"** is.

FROM SIDECAR



Too early looks exactly like wrong.

An AI employee, 24/7, a few bucks a day. Then "AI takes jobs" hit the news and most people were still using AI like Google. **Vine died. TikTok didn't.** Same idea, different year.

Meet them where they are. **Not where you wish they were.**

BUSINESS TWO · THE ONE I DIDN'T PLAN

I was volunteering at a thrift store. The average volunteer was 70.

WEEK 1

"Can you help with my phone?"

Sure. Two minutes.

→

WEEK 3

"My smart TV's broken. Do you make house calls?"

I guess I do now.

→

WEEK 4

They hand me wads of twenties.

I never asked. I couldn't leave without it.

→

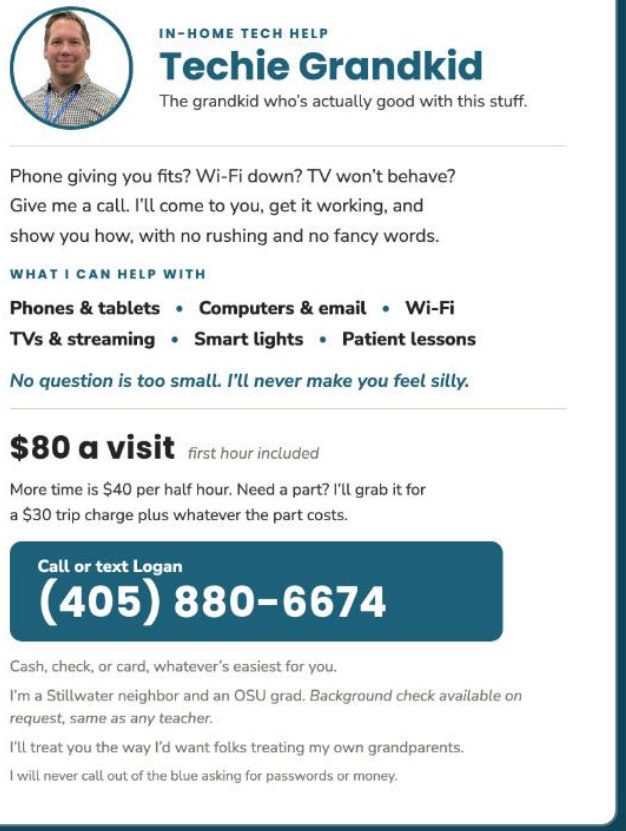
WEEK 5

"Can I share your number?"

That means I need a flyer. Which means I need a price.

A year of planning one business. **The real one walked up and asked for help.**

MY ENTIRE MARKETING DEPARTMENT



IN-HOME TECH HELP

Techie Grandkid

The grandkid who's actually good with this stuff.

Phone giving you fits? Wi-Fi down? TV won't behave? Give me a call. I'll come to you, get it working, and show you how, with no rushing and no fancy words.

WHAT I CAN HELP WITH

Phones & tablets • **Computers & email** • **Wi-Fi**
TVs & streaming • **Smart lights** • **Patient lessons**

No question is too small. I'll never make you feel silly.

$80 a visit *first hour included*

More time is $40 per half hour. Need a part? I'll grab it for a $30 trip charge plus whatever the part costs.

Call or text Logan
(405) 880-6674

Cash, check, or card, whatever's easiest for you.

I'm a Stillwater neighbor and an OSU grad. *Background check available on request, same as any teacher.*

I'll treat you the way I'd want folks treating my own grandparents.

I will never call out of the blue asking for passwords or money.

One flyer. Zero ads, ever.

"$60 a visit. Would anyone actually pay this?" They texted it to their friends. Now it's $80 and they still do.

Last week, a packages sheet: $40 half-hour blocks at the sign-up table, $20 to scam-proof a phone. Three price changes, every one from a customer conversation, not a spreadsheet.

One regular, Sally, sends more referrals than anyone. She talked me into an Apple Watch class, then filled the room herself.

Sell it before you build it. **A flyer is a business plan you can hand to someone.**

I DIDN'T ASK FOR ANY OF THIS

"I'll work in tech, I don't need people skills." Watch this.

A networking event
"What's your day job?" I gave the Shimmer pitch. Then mentioned nights and weekends.

→

A home-care owner
"I need to introduce you to someone."

→

Four senior communities
Primrose, Golden Oaks, Legacy Village, Stillwater Medical. In one week.

→

A sponsored talk. It happened.
"Don't Get Robbed Online," Oct 16 at Primrose. **30 people** and a sign-up sheet.

Monday, November 2, I'm back at Primrose to lock down phones and answer questions, one half hour at a time. Every one of those rooms was full of my customers, and **not one dollar of advertising got me there. All of it was a conversation.**

The tech is the product. **The relationships are the distribution.**

THE CUSTOMER YOU KEEP SKIPPING

My ideal customer looks nothing like me.

The app I built for me

EventSnag: screenshot a flyer, it lands on your calendar. The customer was someone new to town, like me.

- I built every feature I wanted
- Turns out that's a very small club
- And it doesn't have much money
- Zero paying users

Techie Grandkid's customer

Retired, offline, frustrated with a phone. Nothing like me.

- **Money.** They write checks without blinking.
- **Need.** A real, daily, annoying problem.
- **Enthusiasm.** So grateful they text their friends about it.
- **Overlooked.** Everyone my age says "just make an app." They don't use apps.

Your team's customer

All three proposals target students like you. Run the same four checks.

- **Money.** Do they have it, or do they have a Pell Grant?
- **Need.** Daily and annoying, or nice to have?
- **Enthusiasm.** Would they text a friend about you?
- **Overlooked.** Who already serves them? Who serves nobody?

Your customer probably doesn't look like you. **Go find who's being ignored.**

FREE MARKET RESEARCH

The bar test. Same guy, two pitches.

Shimmer Labs

"I help local businesses automate the stuff they hate with AI."

1 in 5

gets it

Most say **"ah, ok"** and change the subject.

Techie Grandkid

"I go to older folks' houses and fix their phones and Wi-Fi."

Everyone

understands it

Most say **"Can you help my mom?"** or **"I need you to come by."**

If you can't explain it to a stranger at Stone Cloud, **your customer can't explain it to their friend either.**

YOUR TURN

Ask me anything.
Especially about the failures.

Proposal's done. Brand is this week, marketing is Monday, money after that. Point these at your own team.

CUSTOMER

Who's in your empty chair, by name?

OVERLOOKED

Who has the money and the need, and looks nothing like you?

PRICING

What would ten happy customers say about your price?